

SEA LIFE

Nearly three-quarters of the Earth is covered by oceans and seas. These billions of gallons of salty water are home to silent sharks, playful dolphins, enormous whales, huge marine turtles, fascinating octopuses with their eight long arms, masses of shellfish, and fish of all shapes and sizes. Beautiful underwater gardens of brightly colored coral provide a home for stinging sea anemones, showy sea slugs, giant clams, and spiny sea urchins.

Many parts of the world's seas and oceans are too deep, dark, and cold to support a lot of life, although the animals that live there are among the strangest on the planet. We are just beginning to explore this mysterious, watery world using special deep-sea submersibles. Almost every visit reveals forms of life that scientists have never seen before.



Leatherback
turtle



Coral reef



Blue whale



Tropical
sundial shells